

Memory. It's the very thing that prevents you from cracking that nasty joke in a group setting about short people. Why? You remembered your best friend telling you their insecurity about their height, so this would clearly make them uncomfortable. This way of using memory as a calibration mechanism, as a mid step between retention and disclosure, initially enticed me to build Kivi along the same idea. More so because it is very easy to extract a psychological profile of a user from their dictations. But designing Kivi to extract an ontology of users' goals, motivations and self-image results in it being a product that studies the user. Exactly what I didn't envision Kivi to be.

Hummm, so what does Kivi remember then? Kivi remembers your work. Entities, preferences and episodes. Priya is your client. Acme is the new project. You prefer your emails concise and not verbose. This makes Kivi a smart colleague in your room. It saves the user time and effort by avoiding the need to re-explain.

Sounds pretty basic? There's more to it. Kivi can be dialled into 2 modes: Anbu and Kootu. Anbu is your assistant who says the result based on what you explicitly said. Kootu uses everything Anbu uses plus observations of patterns across your past conversations. For example, if the user asks, "Set up the Atlas pricing Section for Friday", Anbu might remark, "Done, scheduled for Friday". Kootu mode may have Kivi responding, "Done-Friday. You moved this deadline 3 times: the 4th, 9th and 13th. Still want Friday?"

Also, Kivi stores across three axes: Stated, observed and hypothesised. A stated preference is a rule. An observed preference is a pattern that Kivi won't silently enforce. Hypotheses are stored as questions, never as claims.

Most importantly, Abstention is what Kivi does when it's unsure. It says what it doesn't have and mentions what it looked for. No guesses. To top it all, every memory shows its provenance-its actual transcript with a date.

In the human world, we are often told not to care about what others think of you, simply because it's not in our hands. Well, with Kivi, it is 100% in your hands. Every memory is not only visible, but also editable and removable. This lays the foundation for strong user control and trust -exactly why one would keep returning to using it.